Prodigy Anesthesia Quick Review

Hiatal Hernia

What is a hiatal hernia?	A hiatal hernia is a defect that permits a portion of the stomach to move upwards into the thoracic cavity through a weakness in the diaphragm. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 778.*
List and describe 4 types of hiatal hernias.	Type 1 (sliding hernia) results from the fundus of the stomach and the esophageal junction sliding upward. Type 2 (paraesophageal hernia) is a hiatal hernia in which the esophagogastric junction stays in its normal anatomical position, but a small portion of the stomach herniates next to the junction via the esophageal hiatus. Type 3 (mixed hernia) is the combination of a sliding and paraesophageal hernia. Type 4 is the result of the small bowel, colon, or other organs being located in the hernial sac created by a paraesophageal hernia. *Nagelhout JJ, Plaus KL. Nurse Anesthesia. 5th ed. St. Louis, MO: Elsevier Saunders Company; 2014: 778.*
What is the main symptom of a hiatal hernia?	Burning, retrosternal pain that usually happens following a meal *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 1036-1037.*
What other disorder often occurs concurrently in patients with a hiatal hernia?	Peptic esophagitis *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 1036-1037.*
What is the main goal of a surgically corrected hiatal hernia?	The main goal is a return in gastroesophageal integrity. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 1036-1037.*
Are aspiration precautions implemented when inducing a patient with a hiatal hernia?	Although the majority of patients with a hiatal hernia do not exhibit symptoms of reflux esophagitis, aspiration precautions upon the induction of general anesthesia are highly suggested. *Longnecker DE, Newman MF, Brown DL, Zapol WM. Anesthesiology. 2nd ed. New York: McGraw-Hill; 2012: 1036-1037.*

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